



Digg accident

Oops! Google revealed that it had accidentally removed Digg from its search results. We don't think it was a big deal



500px's download milestone

The immensely popular photo-sharing service - 500px is about to cross 500,000 downloads. It also updated its Android app

exit to their destination. The system has been massively backed for solving the problems of everyday, intra-city commute, and has already been applied (with good success) at places such as the London airport, Netherlands, and an early version has been running in Virginia, USA, since 1975! To top the excitement off, even India is expected to implement a prototype in Amritsar by 2015.

Piggybacking

Now this is one concept so intrinsically in keeping with who we are as a species, that it is almost surprising that we are still talking about this as something that 'could' probably happen in the future. The meaning of the word 'piggybacking', as Google would have us believe, is to 'mount or attach something with something else'. Essentially hitchhiking. So the way that

along the route, into the stream. That way, everything reaches in one single energy-sapping flow of the material. And if we were to extend the plan to human, then you would probably have a sealed compartment in there somewhere, with a handful of other people, practically riding water all the way to your destination. Not exactly the most grandiose of plans, but works pretty well in theory.

Back to the... pedals?

If we can promise one thing, it is that poets and old-timers all across the world would be dancing around singing some tune to the words "I told you so". There has been a great emphasis on the use of recyclable energy in order to get around, and what better (or more poetic) way to get recyclable energy than from a cycle? That is probably generalising a little too

ture. Caution: not for the people who like their travels without moving a muscle - because here you will have to move plenty.

You thought that was whacky?

A lot of these above ideas would have you believe that somebody has probably gone out of their way to make the future seem very, well, futuristic. As early as the times of Tesla, efforts have been made to create the 'next big thing' in global transportation. And reading from the book of Tesla (figuratively speaking, of course), if we're talking about a means of global transportation, then why don't we make the globe a means of transportation? That is correct - he drew up a plan to create a 'ring' around the Earth's equator, which, by the virtue of being solidly wrapped around the world, would have nowhere to fall, and would just hang around (pun being intended here) just a little way above the ground. And because it would essentially be detached from the Earth in an independent orbit, we could always trust reactionary forces to have it saved from the Earth's rotation speed. So, relatively speaking, you now have a ring around the world that can have wagons hitched onto it, and circling the Earth at a thousand miles an hour (it is, of course, the other way around in absolute sense). Then again, maybe it is easier to implement than what is essentially an albatross around the neck of the astro community - the Space Elevator. Although it has been planned to cater to a very niche requirement, but saying that just doesn't do justice to the ambitious ideas we are talking about here. The plan is to, quite literally, create an elevator from a stationary base on Earth, which would be tied to a space station that floats directly above the ground at the exact height for the orbit to be geostationary - and the connecting material would be an elevator tube, which would be used to send items and people up to what will be the highest possible floor known to man, at a fraction of the cost of what it is today, with these money-burning rockets and stuff. What has us most deeply concerned is the fact that the life of this elevator's operator would be simultaneously one of



Hipster science - because normal elevators are too mainstream

we've proposed this to happen, is that there could be grids of huge pipelines that could be transporting essential materials across the world, and somewhere along in the the luggage, there would be compartments where we would be transported as well. Say, for example, there is a pipeline that transports water from Punjab to Rajasthan. This water, because of its flow, has a lot of dormant energy that is not being put to use. It can be, if we also put in all the goods and materials transported

much, but this is a concept that has generated a lot of buzz. There is a project called 'Shweeb' that is being implemented in New Zealand, wherein people will pedal to their destinations in what are essentially bicycle pods. This project, as green and cheery as it sounds, has received more than a few solid backings - not in the least from Google, who have devoted resources, monetary and otherwise, to help the project to develop from a promising prototype to a solid production-ready infrastruc-